Policies Tips and Tricks

Business Academy Group Learning · Policies · May 2027

Clear policies make your program fair, protect your income, and save you from repeating the same hard conversations.

Cover the essentials

- **Tuition and payment.** Rates, due dates, late fees, and what happens after nonpayment.
- **Absences and vacations.** Whether tuition is due when children are out.
- **Hours and pickup.** Late pickup fees and who can pick up a child.
- **Closures.** Holidays, weather, emergencies, and how tuition is handled.
- **Health and illness.** When children stay home and when they can return.

Write policies people understand

- **Plain language.** Short sentences, no jargon.
- **Specific details.** Exact times, amounts, and dates.
- **Clear consequences.** Say what happens if the policy isn't followed.
- **Translate if needed.** Offer the handbook in the languages your families speak.

Put policies to work

- **Get signatures.** Families sign that they received and read the handbook.
- **Review at enrollment.** Walk new families through the most important policies.
- **Apply them consistently.** Exceptions for one family create problems with others.
- **Post key policies.** Hours, late fees, and illness rules near the door.

Keep them current

- **Review once a year.** Update policies to match how your program really runs.
- **Give written notice.** Share changes ahead of time with a start date.
- **Check licensing.** Confirm your policies meet current Virginia licensing standards.

Don't forget staff

- **Write a staff handbook.** Schedules, call-outs, time off, pay schedule, and expectations.
- **Review it at hiring.** Have staff sign that they received it.

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check current Virginia licensing standards and consult a qualified professional for legal questions.

Questions? Contact your Business Specialist: [name, email, phone]